

Review of Article One

Chapter 1 and 2:

The article 25-A of the Pakistan constitution sure free and compulsory education to everyone age between five and sixteen . Pakistan has the second highest number of children out of in their world . Some estimate about 11.1 million children age in the age bucket 5-16 . The facilities provided in the government ability of enough teachers in the primary schools with almost 33 percent schools being only one teacher .

About 45 percent of the school building are in unsatisfactory condition. Almost 51 percent of school do not have electricity 36 percent schools don't have drinking water 45 percent do not have toilet facility 35 percent do not boundary wall. On level provincial level even after devolution of education systems to provinces 18 amendment has been no significant improvement in the education sector.

Social accountability looks the process of accountability though the demand side of governance and is a bottom up approach also term vertical form of accountability. It is a practical that encourage public participation to demand accountability from civil servant and service provider. The work bank define it is process where ordinary citizens and civil society organization than participants directly or indirectly in exacting accountability.

It is enabled the public has to take part in the accountability process that supplements the official government accountability practice and has resulted into diagonal/ hybrid accountability. Further more after the 18 amendment to the constitution of Pakistan, especially the devolution of education to the provisional level it has made the accountability process closer to governed populace as supported by the past literature.

The article 25 -A after 18 amendment asks for provision of free and compulsory education for age between five and sixteen. It lays emphasis on equal and complementary responsibility on the state to provide access to education by overcoming all existing and restrictive that pose hurdle to providing access to quality education

Various studies point out the social accountability has also improved governance in the public realm . The Gujarat state model in the India serves as an example where successfully resulted in

improved allocations and release of funds to priority sector .Further more another example is that of Porto Alegre in Brazil where the involvement of regional assemblies and participatory budgeting council has resulted in an increase in the numbers of children in public schools doubled during the 1989- 1996 period.

Pakistan is one of the lowest in the South Asian region amounting to meagre 2.1 percent of the GDP however there has been an increasing trend in the total education spending over the past few years especially the province spending more on education from their allocated budget after 18th amendment.

One of the many reasons for quality public education being inaccessible is the disengagement between the policies, data and budgetary allocations. Unless and until these three components establish a secure connection and are coupled with transparent and efficient accountability process. It will be tough to achieve fruitful and sustainable educational development on the provisional level .

Chapter 3 Review

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Group : 06

The report “**Do Schools Get Money? 2016**” is discussing about the educational funds and their uses which the government of Pakistan is providing for public primary schools. The purpose of this study is to see whether the funds which the government is providing are actually reaching the schools, and if yes then how schools are using these funds.

In this research, a mixed method design is used, which means this research is based on two approaches, quantitative and qualitative. Quantitative means the research that consists of numbers and statistical data, and qualitative means the research that consists of opinions, experiences and understanding the system in detail.

The main focus of this report is on the School Management Committees (SMCs). SMCs basically are a community which **consists of teachers, parents and local community members**. This community works for **school development, solving problems and monitoring the use of funds**.

Objectives of the Report:

1. The first objective of this research was to analyze the school committees' structure and their work to see how these committees are shaped, what their roles are and how effective they are in school management.
2. The second objective was to understand the allocation and process of getting school funds, meaning how schools get funds from the government, which process they go through and what kind of problems they face.
3. The third objective was to understand how the funds are allocated and used. Some schools receive the funds from the government but they do not properly use them for school development and improvement. The research tries to find out the main reasons, like administrative problems, lack of awareness or record keeping issues.

Another goal of this study was to understand the decision making process in schools. Which means when schools receive funds, how they decide where the money will be used, like classrooms, toilets, boundary walls or learning materials.

This research also shows what basic facilities are missing in schools, such as classrooms, toilets, boundary walls or furniture. It helps in understanding that if funds are provided, are they fulfilling the needs of schools or not.

In this study, the Public Expenditure Tracking Survey (PETS) tool has been used for collecting data. PETS is basically a method which is used at the international level to see where the government funds are actually used.

In Pakistan, the education budget mostly follows a need-based system, meaning the government provides funds according to need instead of a fixed formula. Because of this, sometimes it becomes difficult to track the allocation of funds. To understand this problem, the PETS method is used to collect data at the lowest level.

Conclusion:

Overall, the main purpose of this study is to improve transparency and accountability in the education system and to understand whether the government funds are properly allocated and fulfilling the needs of schools and education.

Chapter 4 – Findings (Khyber Pakhtunkhwa) Review:

In this chapter, the research team **analyzed the data of government primary schools in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KPK)**. The main purpose of this study was to **see the real situation of students, teachers, school committees, school funds and facilities in these schools**. Through the survey, the researchers **collected information about student enrollment, teachers' qualifications, attendance, receiving of funds and the facilities available in schools**. First, the study analyzed students' enrollment and attendance. According to the research, as the class level increases, the number of students becomes less. **For example, in class 1 there were on average 51 students, but in class 5 the number decreased to 42 students. The drop in enrollment was higher in girls' schools.**

In combined schools, where boys and girls study together, the average number of **students was 22 in class 1 and it decreased to 17 students in class 5**. In this research student attendance was also measured in the survey. **On the survey day, the average attendance rate was about 83%.** Which show that around **one student was absent out of every six students from school**. After that, information about teachers was also analyzed. The results showed that most teachers had good educational qualifications. About 38% of the teachers had a Master's degree and around 30% had a Bachelor's degree. Some teachers were also qualified only up to Intermediate and Matric level. Only 1% of teachers had an MPhil degree as their highest qualification. The study also looked at teachers' professional certifications. The most common certification was PTC (Primary Teaching Certificate), which was **held by 53% of the teachers**. The second most common certification was **B.Ed with 24% teachers**. Around **14% teachers had CT certification and 9% teachers had M.Ed certification**. Teachers' attendance was also quite good in the surveyed schools. On the survey day, about 94% teachers were present and only one teacher out of seventeen was absent.

Regarding school funds, the study found that about **75% of the schools received funds during the fiscal year 2015–2016**. However, around 25% schools did not receive any funds in that year. Most of the funds were received in the first and fourth quarters of the year. **In Khyber Pakhtunkhwa there is also a special fund called the Tameer-e-School Fund (TSF)**. This fund is collected from students every month and it is used for small school needs.

On average, schools collected about **Rs. 2,671 per month from students**. The study also analyzed how the funds were used. **It was found that about 66% of the funds were spent on new installations, such as building or adding new facilities in schools. Around 10% of funds were used for repair and maintenance, while 7% were spent on miscellaneous activities.** The condition of school facilities was also checked. Some schools were still facing lack of basic facilities. For example, **around 25% of schools did not have proper toilet facilities and 11% of the schools had a library facility.** However, there were also some positive points. Around **96% of schools received free textbooks** from the government. Also, **about 82% of schools had access to clean drinking water.** The research also showed that combined schools, **where boys and girls study together, generally had better facilities compared to only boys' or girls' schools.** These schools had better access to water, toilets and textbooks. The study also compared different districts. Swat district had the highest student enrollment and also the highest use of school funds. On the other side, Nowshera district had the lowest enrollment among the surveyed districts.

Overall, the findings of this chapter show that government schools in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa have **relatively good teacher qualifications and teacher attendance.** School committees are also active in most schools. But still some problems exist, such as some **schools not receiving funds, lack of basic facilities, and the decrease in student enrollment as the class level increases.**

Chapter 5: Balochistan Case Study

This one stood out - clear, full of detail, yet making you think long after reading. Facts shaped what felt like a distant problem into something close, urgent. Though I knew some things about schools in Pakistan, numbers and stories here changed how I saw them. Real lives showed up in data points, shifting my view without saying so outright.

Out here, what stood out was just how many kids were not in school - buildings crumbling, barely holding up. Some had no real classrooms at all, others went without safe water or working toilets. Seeing that hit hard: getting an education feels like climbing uphill when you start behind every single day.

Talking through PTSMCs brought up some sharp points. Built on solid thinking, these groups aim to pull parents and teachers into running schools together. Yet things fall apart when money runs short, follow-through is thin, and real power stays out of reach. Without steady backing and

someone watching how things go, good plans often stall mid-step. Ideas alone can't carry weight if nothing holds them upright. Success needs more than a blueprint - it takes fuel and attention.

One key piece of the research focused on a new way to manage education funding in Balochistan through clusters. Seen from where students stand, the system has potential since money moves faster to classrooms when routed this way, shaping better spaces to learn. Because support arrives quicker, teaching conditions shift for the better too. Still, staff and locals find themselves drawn into decisions more often than before, which adds another layer of impact. Yet confusion hit many schools early on, with uncertainty lingering today around how things should work exactly. Understanding remains uneven across sites, actions falter as a result. Training people properly shows up once more as something missing but essential.

What stood out was how this approach differed from older efforts such as the Community Support Process. Good planning makes a real difference when people take part. Success isn't guaranteed even with strong frameworks if the way you involve others falls short. That came clear when looking at why PTSMCs didn't work well.

Truth be told, sorting out schools isn't something one group can fix alone - government, classrooms, neighborhoods must line up efforts. Clear actions, ownership of results, knowing where supplies go - that kind of thing matters more than most admit.

This research hits different - it opens eyes to gaps in Pakistan's schools while quietly laying out paths forward. Seeing those uneven opportunities made me pause, then dig deeper into how learning shapes a country's future.

Chapter 6: Social Accountability Framework: A way forward for a collective action on inclusive and equitable education

Reading this chapter felt different. Instead of just pointing out flaws, it walked through them like a map. One thing stood clear - schools face deep issues, yet the text didn't stop there. A path appears when ideas meet reality. Solutions pop up where others only name problems. Most writings float above the ground, but these thoughts dig into soil. Change seems possible when plans match actual classrooms. The framework doesn't shout answers; it lays bricks one by one.

What stood out from this research is how just gathering information and holding talks won't spark real progress. Three years passed with town halls and questionnaires, yet School Management Committees stayed stuck. It hit me then - plans often fail because no one bridges them to actual doing, something seen across government programs. That gap, it turns out, quietly undermines effort after effort.

This idea about people holding systems responsible matters more than most notice. Citizens stepping up - parents, neighbors, anyone nearby - watching how schools run can shift things slowly. A learner might see value here: when everyone owns a piece of the process, change does not fall just on officials' desks. Responsibility spreads wider that way.

What stands out is how clear schools must be about where money goes. Knowing what's spent helps stop misuse, simply because light shines on choices. It matters when regular people see numbers, since hidden details often hide problems. Training folks to read those numbers makes a difference too. Without skills to follow the trail, even open data stays useless.

When people team up through Citizen Joint Action Committees, something shifts. Not just meetings happen - real talk does. Because these groups link neighbors, activists, and city workers, ideas flow across usual lines. Decisions start reflecting more voices. Problem solving becomes less about guessing, more about knowing. Local choices gain depth when different perspectives mix. The process itself builds awareness, slowly. It is not fast change - but steady.

Fairness across genders, openness to all voices, tied with attention to community needs - these pieces shape a system that fits actual life situations. Built around how people really live, particularly in places such as Pakistan, it reflects grounded thinking rather than distant theory.

Truthfully, seeing how education improves only when everyone steps up shifted my view. What stood out was how clear rules, open actions, people owning their role - these things actually move progress forward.

This way of organizing things feels like a needed change, one that could actually help schools work better over time. When done right, lasting upgrades might follow - opening doors to good learning for everyone.

School Council Report

The study explains that society is changing quickly, and this has strongly affected the school system. To improve the quality of education, different groups and committees have been set up in both government and private elementary schools. These include the Village Education Committee (VEC), Parent Teacher Association (PTA), and School Council (SC). Among them, the school council is especially important because it plays a key role in helping schools achieve the goals set out in the National Education Policy (1998–2010).

A school council is a team made up of the school principal, parents, teachers, community members, and administrators working together for school improvement.

The school council works towards revitalizing a well-functioning school system through its positive plan of action and a constructive dialogue with other stakeholders.

A School Management Committee (SMC), also called a school council, is a group at the school level where community members work together and use their own resources to help improve basic education in their area.

Functions

Its major roles or functions are to develop the quality of teaching, properly utilize funds that are provided by the government, implement different schemes devised by the state as well as the central government, create awareness regarding health among the children, provide sanitation facilities, develop school infrastructure, etc.

School Council's Role in School Improvement

School council members show that they see their role as a shared responsibility for improving the school. Parents, teachers, students, and council members all contribute to this collective effort. Some members believe their main duty is to hold meetings with parents and children to create a better learning environment. Others emphasize the need to meet the school's demands, especially in terms of infrastructure. One male member described the school council as "the mother of the school," comparing its role to that of a father in a household providing care, guidance, and support.

Role of School Council

- ☐ School Council's Successes in Terms of Student Enrollment
- ☐ Role of the School Council in Student's Attendance
- ☐ Utilization of Allotted Funds for the Improvement of School Education
- ☐ Role of the School Council in the Development of Physical Infrastructure in the School
- ☐ Role of School Council regarding Monitoring of Teacher Performance

Selection procedure of School Council members

The school council is a group of 7 to 15 people who work together to help the school. The team includes

The Head Teacher: They act as the chairperson and lead the group.

Parents: They make up at least 50% of the council to ensure families have a strong voice.

Teachers: At least one teacher is included as a member.

Community Members: This can include local leaders like retired government workers or other respected neighbors.

Review:

A quick stop at Govt. Boys High School Gulmiri Wala fell into place during the School Council check-in. Head teacher Mr. Muhammad Ashraf Khan showed up for the talk, along with several staff who regularly join council meetings. While some stayed quiet, others shared how things run on the ground. Right away, we felt included thanks to their warm reception and clear backing of our work. Questions came up on how the School Council is built, along with its duties and functions. What stood out was their breakdown of internal organization - how gatherings take place, decisions form, especially those tied to getting better as a school. Running the school itself became part of that conversation too.

Midway through the meeting, the headmaster explained how the school council operates, stressing its role in shaping basic facilities across campuses. Teachers added useful observations, drawing from personal classroom moments. Cooperation ran deep among team members, their openness standing out throughout every interview session. Real schools reveal nuances that documents miss - this trip made that clear by showing councils in motion.

What follows are a few inquiries put to council members

Is the School Council something that matters where you learn? Maybe it helps shape how things work around class decisions.

True enough, the School Council matters a lot around here. Without it, handling day-to-day challenges would be harder. With its help, things run smoother behind the scenes. Because of their involvement, problems get sorted faster than before.

2.How are School Council members selected in your school?

Usually it's people who've been around a while that make up the group. Leading the school, one of those figures often joins. A handful of staff find spots too. Sometimes folks from outside, like parents, get involved instead.

3.How often are meetings conducted?

Most times, people meet once every month. When something pressing comes up, though, they might gather sooner if things demand it.

4. Every person join in when the group talks? Not always clear who speaks up.

Folks generally show up ready to take part, yet now and then someone steps back when life gets heavy with jobs or private matters.

5. What kinds of issues are typically addressed in meetings?

Picture a classroom where desks sit empty too often. Behavior troubles pop up without warning, catching staff off guard. Cracked walls and flickering lights mark the buildings where learning happens. Schedules shift constantly when planning assemblies, sports days, or science fairs. Each fix seems to bring two new problems. Reality rarely matches the plan drawn at the start of the year.

6. Could the School Council have played a role in how things moved forward at school?

Finding better ways to fix everyday problems? That's where the School Council stepped in. Improvements to buildings and spaces came through their clear efforts. Solving things faster started showing results not long after they got involved.

7. How are student concerns managed?

Solutions often come together when students meet up, talking things through until a path clears. While everyone shares thoughts, ideas take shape slowly, shaped by what each person brings.

When problems come up, teachers step in quickly to help sort things out while guiding their students along the way.

8. Are parents actively involved in the School Council?

Not every parent jumps into school matters with the same energy. Though all have a spot on the Council, real involvement shifts from one family to another. A few show up often, asking questions, joining meetings. Others stay back, only stepping in when needed. Presence varies, just like interest levels across households.

9. Does the council help maintain discipline?

A teacher might keep things running smoothly when students act out - that's where the School Council steps in. Rules come from discussions, shaping how everyone behaves on campus. Support flows both ways between staff and council members during tough moments. Structure matters just as much as guidance when issues arise.

Not every choice gets a thumbs up from everyone involved.

Few moments bring clarity like a tough talk around shared goals. Views might clash at first, yet listening shapes outcomes most can live with. A quiet pause often follows such talks - proof enough that space was given, voices heard.

11. Does the School Council improve students' learning environment?

A brighter classroom setting shows up when upgrades happen, yet rules matter just as much. Fixing school problems often ties into how spaces feel day to day. Clearer paths for students appear once structure improves alongside support.

12. What is one suggestion to make the School Council more effective?

A fresh start each week helps. When everyone shows up, ideas flow better. Parents joining in changes the mood. Without their voice, plans feel empty. Meetings that move at a steady pace keep focus sharp. Involvement turns routine talks into real progress.

Suggestions:

Start by setting a steady rhythm for gatherings. Picture each month ticking off another meeting, every member present without exception - this keeps choices grounded. Watch how parents step forward when invited into the fold; their presence breathes life into classroom efforts and echoes support beyond school hours. Hand them clarity before they begin - short guides or clear talks about what being on the council truly means can shift how they contribute. Money matters best unfold in daylight, documented plainly, so no shadow falls where trust needs to stand.

Conclusion:

Looking back, the School Council helps lift teaching quality along with how the school runs day to day. Because it connects families, locals, and staff, things like classroom conditions get better while teamwork grows stronger. Walking through the building showed clear signs - kids behave better, spaces are cared for, progress happens - plus insight into daily operations came through clearly. Right now, the group works fine, though room remains to grow, especially when meeting often or getting everyone involved. With small shifts already suggested, its role could deepen, shaping brighter outcomes across the whole school slowly but surely.